

Data Summary 6/29/2026

Thoughts on Furies: Looking for Homophobia in Disguise

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Research Question Reminder

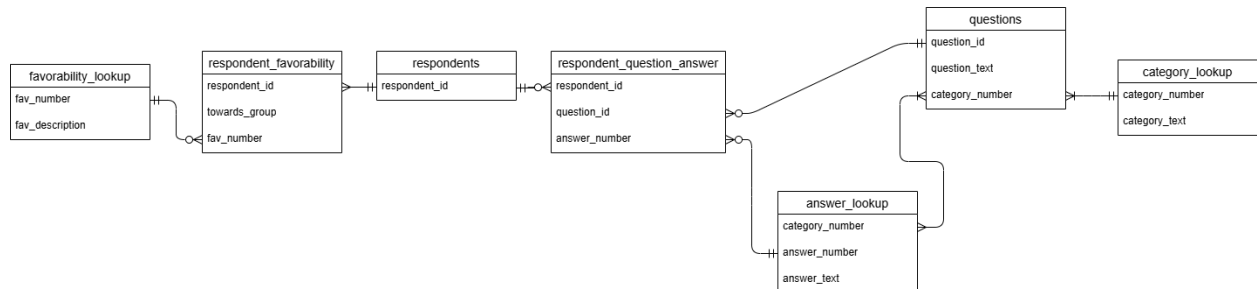
*What proportion of the Furry fandom holds identities under the LGBTQ+ umbrella?
Could individual unfavorable or ignorant sentiments toward furies be associated with unfavorable or ignorant sentiments toward LGBTQ+ people?*

Data Inventory

Description	File/Table Name	Location	Size
Raw answers: Direct download from Google Sheet attached to Google Form, unchanged	`answers-6-28.csv` Changing the name every time I redownload, to keep track of last update	Stored locally	Rows: 122 (current) Columns: 77
Clean answers: All answers with necessary changes such as removed rows (for anonymity and redundancy reasons), added rows (for derived values such as homophobia, etc.), and conversion to UTF-8 (for copying into SQL tables)	`answers_clean.csv`	Stored locally	Rows: 122 (current) Columns: 81
Furscience study data: Data from a survey performed by IARP (Furscience), separate from my own survey, acquired with permission	`2023 Data for Mary.xlsx`	Stored locally	Rows: 1,893 Columns: 6
Respondents table: Just a series from 1 to the number of respondents, useful in the case of respondents who responded to 0 questions (at least one such case exists)	`respondents`	Railway Postgres Database	Rows: 122 Columns: 1

Questions table: Details on every question on the survey including question text and question category	`questions`	Railway Postgres Database	Rows: 75 Columns: 3
Respondent question answer table: A row for each individual response to each individual question, including answer number, respondent ID and question ID	`respondent_question_answer`	Railway Postgres Database	Rows: 9,150 (current) Columns: 3
Answer lookup table: A table to get the selected answer text, given survey section (category) of a question and answer number; number of rows may change if I add on more options for locations and media to have found the survey on	`answer_lookup`	Railway Postgres Database	Rows: 47 (current) Columns: 3
Category lookup table: A lookup table to match category ID to category name	`category_lookup`	Railway Postgres Database	Rows: 8 Columns: 2
Respondent favorability table: A table joining respondents to favorability toward each of three groups, including respondent ID, group ("Furry", "Gay", or "Trans") and a favorability score toward that group	`respondent_favorability`	Railway Postgres Database	Rows: 366 (current) Columns: 3
Favorability lookup table: Matching favorability scores to descriptions, following: 1. Highly favorable 2. Moderately favorable 3. Ambivalent or neutral 4. Unfavorable	`favorability_lookup`	Railway Postgres Database	Rows: 4 Columns 2

Schema & Organization



On either side of the respondent ID table are effectively two different schemas. One relates to the specific answers a respondent gave to survey questions. The other corresponds to derived “favorability scores,” calculated from question answers in R.

The loop between `respondent_question_answer`, `questions`, and `answer_lookup` was a bit of an unconventional choice. However, it was necessary for the purpose of getting answer text, since it relies on both the number of the answer a respondent gave, and the category of the question they were answering, since each question category has a different set of text answers corresponding to answer numbers.

Ingestion Status

My current pipeline needs to be manually repeated each time I would like to add the latest survey responses to the database. I may make some updates for efficiency, but here is the current process:

- 1) The Google Sheet survey responses should automatically update every time a response is submitted, so no action must be taken to update it manually.
- 2) Download survey responses Google Sheet as `answers-mm-dd.csv`
- 3) Run `transform_data.Rmd` (after editing the `read_csv` statement to the current date) to reproduce `answers_clean.csv` and .csv files corresponding to each database table.
- 4) Run an existing SQL script to repopulate database tables with the new data.

Data Quality & Profiling

- I had difficulty with curly quotes when copying csv files made in R into SQL tables, so I replaced each of them with straight single quotes.
- All survey questions are optional and can be skipped at will. In theory, a respondent could skip entire sections (categories) or respond to no questions at all. By now, there

exists one such respondent who answered nothing. So, all data analysis and pipelining must cover for missing values. For example, derived favorability scores are calculated using average, rather than sum, so that no weight is applied to questions with no responses. Also, copy statements used to populate tables include a ``NULL 'NA'`` statement to translate R “NA” into SQL “NULL”.

- The one required question on the survey was consent to participate, and the only available option was “Agree”. This column was removed for redundancy.
- Different kinds of bias arise from the different populations I am sampling and the different ways I may get their attention. For example, respondents surveyed in an Oregon or Washington town may lean heavily liberal, while respondents from SurveySwap.io or r/SurveyExchange are from various parts of the world but may lean more young and educated. If I would like to try collecting responses while dressed in a furry costume, I may draw the attention of people with more favorable attitudes, or make their attitudes more favorable than they otherwise would have been, through positive interaction. So, I have made sure to ask questions that cover which attention groups a respondent is part of so that these biases may be considered in analysis.

Reproducibility

Steps to reproducing ``answers_clean.csv`` (assuming access to raw survey answers):

- 1) Download the Google Sheet of responses as a .csv (comma-separated values) file, ``answers-mm-dd.csv``.
- 2) In your data analysis programming language of choice, read ``answers-mm-dd.csv`` into a data frame, ``answers``.
- 3) Drop the first two columns. The first one is a timestamp, which threatens anonymity. The second one is redundant, because it is a consent agreement that all respondents gave the same answer to.
- 4) Optional: rename all columns to short and easily queryable codenames.
- 5) Also optional: save previous column names to keep track of question text.
- 6) Write a function to calculate a score given: a section of questions, which questions from that section to exclude from the calculation (if any), and which questions to reverse-score, which should work as follows:
 - a) Ignore all values outside the section and any specified values to be excluded within the section.
 - b) Set all reverse scored values to themselves multiplied by negative one, then adding 6. This should change values of 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5 to 5, 4, 3, 2, and 1 respectively.
 - c) Get the mean of all included values.
 - d) Reverse the result by multiplying it by negative one and then adding 6.
 - e) Return the final result.
- 7) Set a raw furry favorability score to the result of your function, with inputs as:

- a) Section: questions 1-24
 - b) Exclude: 1, 2, 3, 4
 - c) Reverse: 5, 10, 16, 19
- 8) Set a raw gay favorability score to the result of your function, with inputs as:
 - a) Section: questions 25-44
 - b) Exclude: none
 - c) Reverse: 29, 34, 39, 40
- 9) Set a raw trans favorability score to the result of your function, with inputs as:
 - a) Section: questions 45-66
 - b) Exclude: none
 - c) Reverse: 45, 46, 49, 50, 52, 53, 54, 55, 65
- 10) Set three thresholds for favorability category assignment as
 - i) 1.5
 - ii) 2.5
 - iii) and 3.5.
- 11) From your three continuous raw favorability scores, and using your thresholds, calculate a final ordinal categorical favorability score such that:
 - a) Raw values from 1 up to and not including 1.5 are set to 1 ("Highly favorable").
 - b) Raw values from 1.5 up to and not including 2.5 are set to 2 ("Moderately favorable").
 - c) Raw values from 2.5 up to and not including 3.5 are set to 3 ("Ambivalent or neutral").
 - d) Raw values from 3.5 up to and including 5 are set to 4 ("Unfavorable").
- 12) Save data frame `answers` as `answers.csv`.

Ethics & Access Controls

- Drop the timestamp column from my survey responses, because it threatens anonymity when matched to comments on r/SurveyExchange announcing completion.
- Publishing data is one of the conditions that respondents agreed to take my survey under, and thus they consent to any public sharing, such as Grafana dashboards.
- Never publishing or sharing data is one of the conditions that I agreed to receive IARP (Furscience) data under, and thus I will not be uploading them to any database.

Freeze Statement

As stated in the proposal, I will continue data acquisition until Monday, July 27th, after which point I will finalize and make no further changes to the database. Until this point, I will be able to perform all planned data analysis, though any conclusions may not be as strong as after the database is frozen at its full length. Though I am already five eighths of the way to my goal of 200 responses, now knowing that my goal was realistic, I will now aim to exceed that initial goal.